

consumer economy, a lot of work needs to be done to improve social infrastructure.

Digital infrastructure: Currently, India is all set to enter the 5G era. It won't be long before we catch up with our global counterparts. 5G will not merely boost internet speeds but will also rapidly bring economic progress and boost job creation across urban and emerging markets. Our future endeavour should be to leapfrog in technology adoption, setting new global benchmarks.

Tech as 'sutraddhar': Businesses and citizens today are certainly more resilient to disruptions because of access to technologies like mobile, cloud and automation, as evidenced during the pandemic. India has already led with first of its kind successful innovations like UPI, UIDAI and CoWIN—these are innovations that India can now take to the world.

Over the next few years, we must look at leveraging the flexibility of hybrid cloud combined with the power of AI and the potent

the right policies, investments in building skills and world-class infrastructure. For a country as big as ours, no single organisation can accomplish that, which puts emphasis on leveraging the power of partnerships between these key pillars of our economic growth.

Tapping diversity and inclusion:

India has a unique advantage when it comes to diversity and inclusion. This allows India to be the world's innovation lab that others can learn from. It's important we consciously nurture and protect our diverse ethos as our unique differentiator.

Sustainable competitiveness:

Global energy demands are shifting towards electrification and renewables. For a country like ours, using fossil fuel alternatives is especially important and will have a two-pronged effect. First it would provide a cleaner environment and, second, make India self-reliant for its energy needs. In addition, encouraging businesses to adopt a circular economy model could build India's sustainable competitiveness.

Trust and security: As technology becomes ubiquitous, so does cybersecurity concerns. To strengthen people's trust in technology, we need to implement a robust security architecture using principles of confidential computing to protect their data at all stages—when it is stored, while being transferred and even when being used by an application.

In conclusion, these areas I have highlighted are not utopian or implausible. Most of this is already happening in some form or shape. Let's keep our eyes on the prize and execute every day to get there. **BT**

The writer is Managing Director of IBM India/South Asia

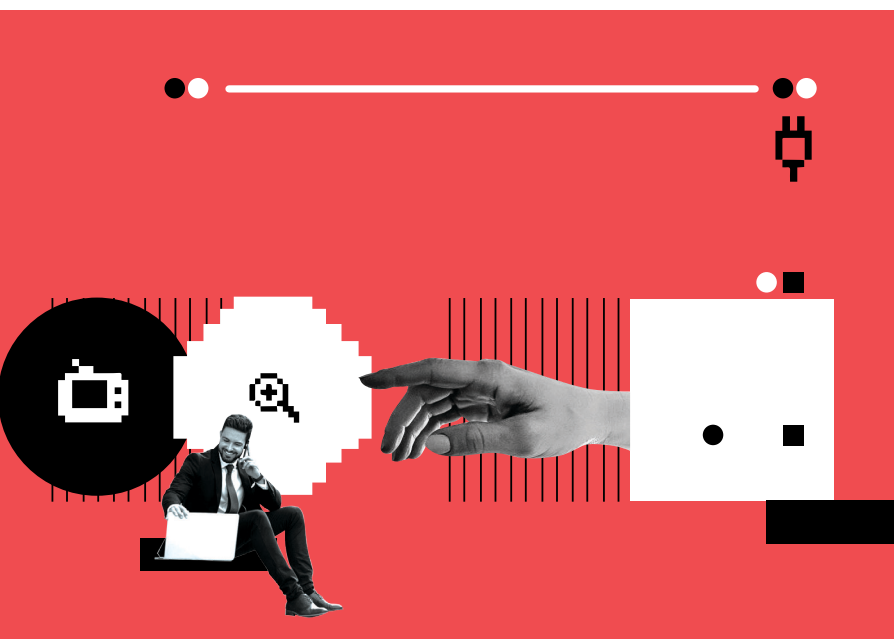


ILLUSTRATION BY ANIRBAN GHOSH

Golden demographics: One new way of thinking would be to truly unlock the demographic dividend and diversity of skills available across our nation. A part of this progressive growth is already underway. For instance, tech in India is no longer defined by metros and the next wave of innovation is coming from emerging cities like Ahmedabad, Kochi, Coimbatore and Bhubaneswar, among others.

problem-solving power of quantum computing. Together these three will open doors to solutions that were unthinkable up until now.

Power of partnerships: To unlock India's true potential is to create a supportive ecosystem through deeper collaboration between the government, industry and academia. The next phase of creating a 'Suvarna Aatma Nirbhar Bharat' requires